

User research

What this tool produces · *A documented mapping of citizen needs, limitations, and actual interactions with public services, synthesized into clear action points for the design phase.*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Dimensions

Social / User

Spatial

Preparing the workshop · *User research*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Why this tool matters

Forcing the administration to step out of the office and look the resident in the eye, ensuring that services are molded around real human lives rather than forcing humans to fit bureaucratic boxes.

Evidence we produce

A documented mapping of citizen needs, limitations, and actual interactions with public services, synthesized into clear action points for the design phase.

Duration & Material

Duration · 3 to 4 weeks of field study and synthesis

Material · Interview guides, observation matrices, recording equipment

Reference case

The UN Global Pulse lab in Jakarta applied human-centred design principles directly to data governance and public service design. By prioritizing rigorous user research, they ensured that new services were driven by the actual experiences and needs of the citizens, rather than relying solely on quantitative data .

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Interview guide · persona × scenario × insights

Duration
3 to 4 weeks of field study and synthesis

Persona

Name · age · context · job-to-be-done

Scenario

A specific moment we want to study (a vulnerable resident accessing a public service)

Warm-up

*Open with a recent experience
Get the user talking*

- Q1.** _____
- Q2.** _____
- Q3.** _____

Dive

*Map the actions step by step
Observe frictions in real time*

- Q1.** _____
- Q2.** _____
- Q3.** _____

Wrap-up

*Surface what they would change
If magic was possible*

- Q1.** _____
- Q2.** _____
- Q3.** _____

Insights captured · barriers to remove · design requirements

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.